

D-Link DWL-2100AP**Slowcoach to Wi-Fi town...**

The DWL-2100AP is well-built, sturdy, but light. It's also wall-mountable; a complete kit is provided. D-Link's firmware interface is good, but not as well laid-out as on the Compex products. The manual that accompanies this device is more informative than that that came with the other brands.

We were disappointed to see the scores on the DWL-2100AP. At 0.12 MBps it's a whopping 500 per cent slower than the ASUS WL-530G when it comes to transferring files across relatively larger distances!



Although it was faster than the Compex trio while transferring single large files, it lagged behind while transferring a bunch of smaller files. The movie streaming test also saw this AP trail behind what is acceptable for watching seamless video.

It's not suitable for file transfers or movie streaming if you intend to set up your server and client on different floors, or if the distance between AP and client is anything over 15 feet. At a price of Rs 3,990, you'd be better off buying the blazingly fast WL-530G, which throws in routing capabilities as well.

Linksys WAT54G**The best access point out there!**

The WAT54G is the AP equivalent of the WRT54G. Instead of just dropping out a few features (which it does), the WAT54G adds one: bridging capabilities. Besides the lack of the four RJ45 connects at the rear, the two devices look identical!

The firmware interface is identical to that of the WRT54G, aside from the lack of routing functions.

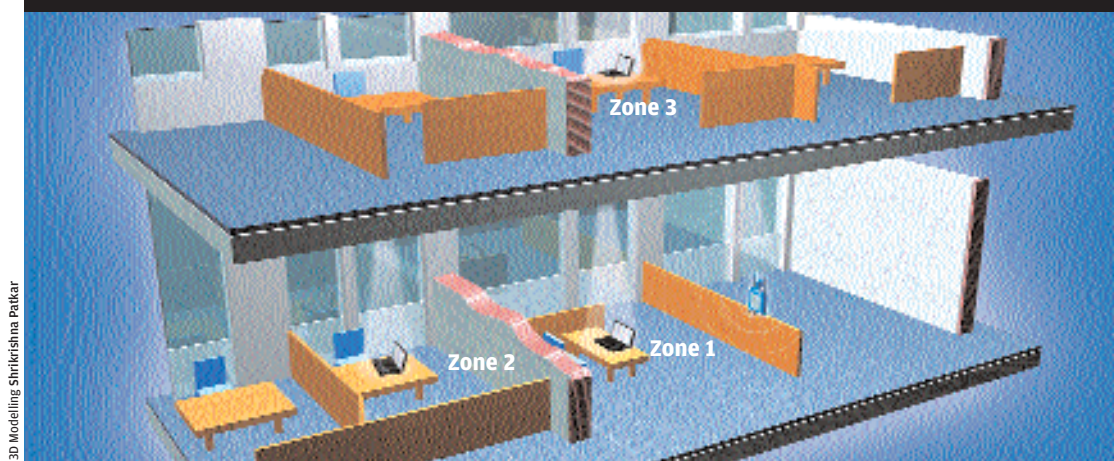
The WAT54G smoked the competition in our data transfer tests—its 0.66 and 0.53 MBps in Zone 1 (single and multiple file respectively) are faster than those of either of its brethren. Curiously, the WAT54G was actually faster in Zone 2—0.67 and



0.56 MBps, as compared to Zone 1. We ran our tests again just to be sure; while the results weren't identical (wireless transfers rarely are), they were consistent.

The WAT54G is a great access point, very deserving of accolades.

We recognize this and reward Linksys on a great product with our Digit Best Buy Gold award.

Our Test Zones 1, 2 and 3 Demystified

3D Modelling Shikrishna Patkar

**A Decision Maker**

You Want	You Need	We Recommend
Wireless connectivity to your laptop from your desktop PC	An Access Point (AP)	Linksys WAT54G
To set up a small home network, between two PCs and your laptop or Wi-Fi enabled PDA	A Wireless Router	ASUS WL-530G, Linksys WRT54G
To stream movies from your PC's hard drive to your laptop(s) wirelessly	A Wireless Router/ AP	ASUS WL-530G, Senao ECB-3220
To set up a small office network wirelessly, complete with a network printer	A Wireless Router	ASUS WL-600G, Compex NP27G
An ADSL modem and a wireless router for a broadband connection, preferably wireless-enabled	A Wireless ADSL Router	Netgear DG834G, ASUS WL-600G